

Rifles and Muskets

Infantry arms were in transition in the Civil War. Most were percussion-firing rifled weapons, like modern firearms, rather than smoothbore, flintlock muskets. But most were muzzle-loaded, unlike modern breechloading firearms.



❶ Model 1822 Springfield musket (Confederate and Union) Both sides used older firearms, such as this Model 1822, manufactured at the Springfield Armory in Massachusetts. It has been converted from a flintlock firing system to the more modern percussion system.



❷ Model 1841 Mississippi rifle (Confederate and Union) An accurate .54-caliber percussion rifle, often carried by Confederate NCOs, skirmishers, and sharpshooters.



❸ Pattern 1853 Enfield rifle musket (Confederate and Union) This British weapon was highly prized by both sides. After the Model 1861, it was the second most widely used infantry weapon of the war.